

STAGE SIXTEEN • WORKPLACE PROFESSIONALISM & ETHICS

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Sixteen • Workplace Professionalism & Workplace Readiness / Professional Ethics & Integrity

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what expectation are you unsure about, what boundary are you setting, what's your ethical framework?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience of professionalism and integrity, day to day?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these during share-out portions, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy needs a genuine, specific prompt rather than “any volunteers?” They're organized by session, four prompts each.

The Session 4 and 5 prompts touch genuinely sensitive territory — ethical shortcuts, pressure from authority, what people would say about your integrity when you're not in the room. Treat these with real care: an open prompt should never function as an implicit demand that someone disclose a specific real lapse or pressure they've faced.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Workplace Fundamentals

"What's a workplace habit you had to unlearn when you started a new role?"

"Has anyone ever given you direct feedback about your punctuality or reliability? How did it land?"

"What's an example of initiative you took that genuinely paid off, even though no one asked you to do it?"

"What's been the hardest part of adapting to a new organizational environment, if you've done that recently?"

SESSION 2

Navigating Workplace Situations

"Has a boundary you set at work ever been received better than you expected?"

"Describe a time you had to guess at priority because you couldn't reach your manager in time. How did it turn out?"

"What's the difference between how you've seen a mistake handled well versus handled poorly?"

"Has an accountability conversation you avoided ever gotten worse specifically because you waited?"

SESSION 3

Performance & Professional Identity

"What's the most useful piece of performance feedback you've ever received, and what made it useful?"

"Has your self-perception of your own reliability ever genuinely differed from how a colleague described you?"

"What's a workplace value you've seen genuinely lived out, not just posted on a wall somewhere?"

"Looking at your own professional standard statement, is there a line in it you're not fully living up to yet?"

SESSION 4

Ethical Foundations & Responsibilities

"Has a rule ever felt technically satisfied but genuinely missed the underlying point it was meant to serve?"

"Have you ever had to disclose a conflict of interest, or wished you had? What happened?"

"What's a moment you chose honesty even though a small, convenient omission would have been easier?"

"Has AI-generated content ever given you something that turned out to be wrong? What did you learn from catching it, or not catching it?"

SESSION 5

Applied Ethics & Integrity Reflection

"Have you ever felt real pressure from someone with authority over you to cut an ethical corner? What did you do?"

"What would you want people to say about your integrity if you weren't in the room?"

"Has there been a moment you considered speaking up about something and didn't? What would help you do it next time?"

"Looking back across this entire stage, both professionalism and ethics, what's the single area you most want to keep working on?"